

Public Inspection Notice - Statement of Accounts 2024/25
Notice of the Commencement of the Period for the Exercise of Public Rights
The Local Audit and Accountability Act 2014
The Accounts and Audit Regulations 2015
Local Audit (Public Access to Documents) Act 2017

The period for the exercise of public rights commences on the 16 June 2025 and will conclude at 4pm on the 25 July 2025.

The following documents will be made available:

- The Narrative Statement (Introduction to the 2024/25 Accounts)
- The Statement of Accounts
- The Annual Governance Statement

The Council's accounts are subject to external audit by Emma Larcombe, Director of KPMG LLP, c/o 15 Canada Square, Canary Wharf, London E14 5GL. E-mail: Emma.Larcombe@KPMG.co.uk

1. From 9 am on 16 June 2025 to 4pm on 25 July 2025 any person may inspect the accounting records of the Council for the financial year to 31 March 2025, and certain related documents (comprising books, deeds, contracts, bills, vouchers and receipts) by prior arrangement at the address given below. They may also make copies of the accounts and documents at the following address.

Finance and Resources, Southend-on-Sea City Council, Civic Centre, Victoria Avenue, Southend-on-Sea, SS2 6ER.

2. It would be helpful and save time if any person wishing to exercise their right to inspect the Council's accounting records makes appropriate arrangements in advance, by contacting the Council's Finance Team by emailing accountancyreturns@southend.gov.uk. A person is not entitled to inspect or copy any part of any record or document containing:
 - Information which is protected on the grounds of commercial confidentiality
 - Personal information
3. From 9 am on 16 June 2025 to 4pm on 25 July 2025 at the request of a local government elector, the local auditor must give the elector, or any representative of the elector, an opportunity to question the auditor about the accounting records of the Council. Please contact the auditor at the address given above to make arrangements to ask any questions.
4. From 9 am on 16 June 2025 to 4pm on 25 July 2025 a local government elector for the area of the Council or his/her representative may object to the Council's accounts asking that the auditor issue a report in the public interest or apply for a declaration that an item of account is unlawful under section 28 of the Local Audit and Accountability Act 2014. Written notice of the proposed objection and the grounds on which it will be made must be sent to the auditor at the contact details given above and also copied to the Council at the address given below. A comprehensive guide to your rights can be found at <https://www.nao.org.uk/code-audit-practice/council-accounts-a-guide-to-your-rights/>

Joe Chesterton
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